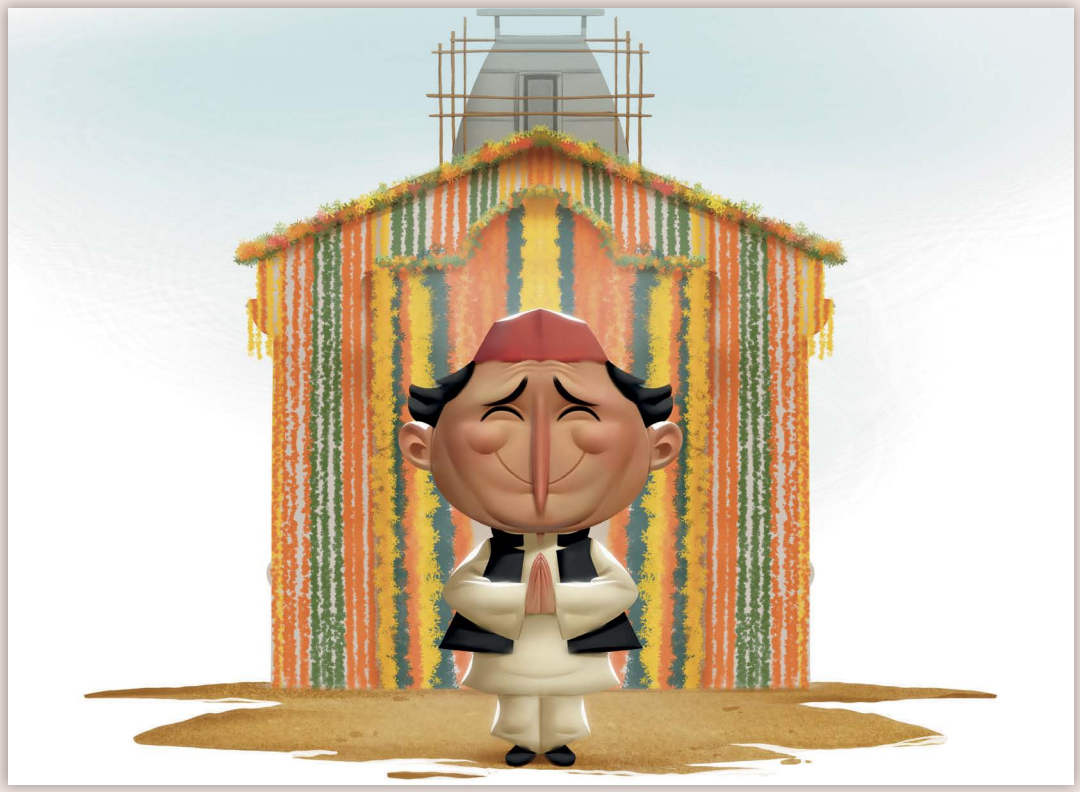
▼ GLASSHOUSE



AKHILESH JOINS THE TEMPLE RUN

If you can't beat them, join them. At his ancestral home in Etawah, Samajwadi Party chief **Akhilesh Yadav** has commissioned a Rs 50 crore Kedareshwar Mahadev Temple, said to be a replica of the famed Kedarnath temple in Uttarakhand. The complex already houses a child idol of Lord Ram, installed on Ramnavami, with the formal inauguration of the main temple set for the Sawan Shivaratri this August. On the face of it, the move blends faith and personal legacy. Politically, for a leader often boxed into a 'pro-Muslim' image, the temple offers a visible counter, what some SP watchers called a "calibrated step into the BJP's cultural terrain...but without the loud rhetoric". The timing is just right. Uttar Pradesh has an assembly election coming up in 2027, and in a state where religion and politics often overlap, even a temple at his home base can carry a larger message.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ JAGAN'S 3Cs PROJECT

CAPITAL CONJUROR

Former Andhra Pradesh chief minister **Jagan Mohan Reddy**'s fascination with a three-cornered capital for the state hasn't abated, it seems. This, even as Parliament has passed an amendment legitimising the status of Amaravati—TDP chief and current CM **Chandrababu Naidu**'s choice—as the state's sole capital (perhaps the only such instance in the country). Jagan and his YSR Congress



government (2019-24) had pursued a decentralised, three-capital plan, but it bottomed out after his party lost. Now, he's manifesting a Plan-B, a 'capital corridor development', connecting port-town Machilipatnam and two cities, Vijayawada and Guntur. Amaravati, as expected, lies outside this Jagan plan. The YSRCP chief has even found a catchy acronym, MaViGun, which is fast becoming a trollers' delight with more and more absurd interpretations of it coming out each day.